

Besher Alkurdi

AI Engineer specializing in Generative AI systems, efficient inference, and deployment

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📍 Jyvaskyla, Finland (Relocatable)

EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant and Teacher** at [University of Jyvaskyla](#) Nov 2025 - Present
 - Built multimodal AI pipeline for video and audio analysis as part of "The Rhythm of Life" research project.
 - Managed NLP course for AI students including project supervision and assessment.
- Research Engineer** at [Huawei](#) Aug 2023 - Aug 2024
 - Enhanced distributed training library with PEFT, context expansion, and stabilization techniques using ZeRO, FSDP, DeepSpeed, achieving 8x resource reduction.
 - Optimized model architectures for standard library compatibility and built scalable multi-backend inference platform with RESTful and streaming APIs.
 - Developed multilingual synthetic data generation toolkit and fine-tuning pipelines for customer adaptations.
 - Conducted requirements analysis and defined PoC roadmaps with cross-functional teams.
- Undergraduate Research Fellow** at [Yildiz Technical University](#) Jun 2022 - Mar 2023
 - Curriculum learning research in publicly funded project using TensorFlow, PyTorch, and Horovod for difficulty-based training strategies.
 - Trained CLIP-style multimodal models with contrastive learning and experimented with auxiliary classifiers for early exit strategies.
- Research Intern** at [New Mind AI](#) Jul 2021 - Oct 2021
 - Researched SOTA NLP techniques for a Document AI system assisting lawyers with Turkish legal documents.

EDUCATION

- MSc. Artificial Intelligence** at University of Jyvaskyla Thesis Phase
- BSc. Computer Science** at [Yildiz Technical University](#) (2nd in class, GPA: 3.84/4) Jun 2023

PUBLICATIONS

- Scaling Up Paraphrase Generation Datasets with MT and Semantic Similarity Filtering 2024
- Semantic Similarity Based Filtering for Turkish Paraphrase Dataset Creation Dec 2022
- Linguistic-based Data Augmentation Approach for Offensive Language Detection 2022

VOLUNTEER

- Volunteer Researcher** at [COSMOS AI Research Group](#) Dec 2024 - Present
 - Researching LLM/VLM performance using unlabeled data and RL; co-trained the strongest Turkish encoder based on ModernBERT architecture.
- Tutor** at [Schoolhouse.world](#) Feb 2021 - May 2021
 - Tutored students worldwide in Math, Computer Science, and related subjects.
- Tutor** at [Aqsa Youth Institution](#) Nov 2020 - Aug 2021
 - Taught computer, networking, and programming basics to middle and high school refugee students.
- Translator** at [Ask Me](#) Jun 2019 - Aug 2019
 - Assisted tourists visiting Istanbul as part of Fatih Municipality volunteer program.

CERTIFICATES

Large-Scale Training (Maven)	Oct 2025	Deep RL Course (HuggingFace)	May 2024
GANs Specialization (DeepLearning.AI)	Jul 2023	NLP Specialization (DeepLearning.AI)	Jun 2023
Deep Learning Specialization (DeepLearning.AI)	Feb 2023	ML Specialization (DeepLearning.AI)	Aug 2022

LANGUAGES

Arabic (Native) - English (Advanced) - Turkish (Advanced) - Finnish (Beginner) - French (Beginner)